

BLAMO CLOSING

Automotive sales training

Meet & Greet Mastery

The First Five Minutes Determine
the Next Five Hours

Training Objective

By the end of this chapter, you'll know how to:

- ✓ Make an unforgettable first impression.
- ✓ Build trust within the first 60 seconds.
- ✓ Read a customer's personality and communication style.
- ✓ Avoid common mistakes that cause customers to put up walls.
- ✓ Become the salesperson customers ask for by name.

Why the Meet & Greet Matters

Most customers decide how they feel about you long before they decide how they feel about the vehicle.

Think about it. A customer can buy the same Honda, Ford, Chevrolet, or Toyota at several dealerships. What they can't get everywhere is you.

The vehicle may bring them onto the lot, but your professionalism, personality, and ability to build trust are what earn their business.

Customers don't buy from salespeople they don't trust.

And trust starts within the first few moments.

The 10-Second Rule

The first ten seconds should never feel rushed.

Smile genuinely. Walk with confidence—not too fast, not too slow. Make eye contact and greet them warmly.

Avoid approaching from behind or surprising them. Walk toward them at a comfortable pace with relaxed shoulders and open hands.

Your goal isn't to "catch" a customer.

Your goal is to make them feel welcome.

Manager's Tip

People don't remember your words nearly as much as they remember how you made them feel.

The Perfect Meet & Greet

Salesperson:

"Good morning! Welcome to ABC Motors."

(Smile.)

"My name is Jake."

(Handshake if appropriate.)

"And yours?"

(Customer responds.)

"Great to meet you, Sarah."

"Thanks for coming in today."

"How's your day been so far?"

Pause.

Listen.

Don't rush.

Notice what didn't happen.

You didn't ask:

"Can I help you?"

Because almost every customer responds:

"Just looking."

Instead, you started a conversation.

First Impressions

Customers are asking themselves questions the moment they see you.

- ✓ Can I trust this person?
- ✓ Are they going to pressure me?
- ✓ Are they listening?
- ✓ Do they care about me or just the sale?
- ✓ Am I going to enjoy working with them?

You answer those questions without realizing it.

Your smile.

Your tone.

Your posture.

Your energy.

Your patience.

Everything communicates something.

Body Language That Builds Trust

DO	DON'T
✓ Smile naturally.	✗ Cross your arms.
✓ Keep your hands visible.	✗ Keep your hands in your pockets.
✓ Stand at a slight angle instead of directly in front of the customer.	✗ Check your phone.
✓ Maintain comfortable eye contact.	✗ Interrupt.
✓ Mirror the customer's energy.	✗ Point aggressively.
✓ Nod while they're talking.	✗ Stand too close.
✓ Lean in slightly when listening.	✗ Talk while walking away.
✓ Walk beside the customer, not ahead of them.	✗ Look toward the showroom instead of the customer.

Building Instant Rapport

Rapport isn't created by talking.

Rapport is created by listening.

Customers like people who are genuinely interested in them.

One of the easiest formulas is:

F	Family
O	Occupation
R	Recreation
M	Motivation

Example:

"So what do you do for work?"
"How long have you been doing that?"
"Sounds like you stay pretty busy."
"What do you like to do when you're not working?"
"Very nice."
"What has you shopping for a vehicle now?"

Within two minutes, you know more about them than most salespeople learn during the entire visit.

Manager's Tip

The person asking the questions controls the conversation.
Customers love talking about themselves.
Give them permission to.

Reading Personality Types

Every customer buys differently.

Great salespeople recognize this early.

The Driver

You'll notice:

- ✓ Fast talker
- ✓ Wants results
- ✓ Direct
- ✓ Doesn't enjoy small talk

How to sell them:

- ✓ Be brief.
- ✓ Be confident.
- ✓ Respect their time.
- ✓ Get to the point.

The Analytical Customer

You'll notice:

- ✓ Lots of questions
- ✓ Researches everything
- ✓ Wants facts
- ✓ Takes notes

How to sell them:

- ✓ Slow down.
- ✓ Show data.
- ✓ Explain features.
- ✓ Don't rush them.

The Friendly Customer

You'll notice:

- ✓ Smiles often
- ✓ Loves conversation
- ✓ Talks about family
- ✓ Easygoing

How to sell them:

- ✓ Build relationships.
- ✓ Share stories.
- ✓ Stay conversational.
- ✓ Don't become too transactional.

The Expressive Customer

You'll notice:

- ✓ Excited
- ✓ Emotional
- ✓ Loves new technology
- ✓ Talks with their hands

How to sell them:

- ✓ Match their enthusiasm.
- ✓ Let them experience the vehicle.
- ✓ Paint a picture of ownership.
- ✓ Focus on excitement.

Questions to Avoid

Some questions immediately create resistance.

Avoid these:

- X "Can I help you?"
- X "Are you buying today?"
- X "What's your budget?"
- X "How much do you want your payment to be?"
- X "Do you have good credit?"
- X "What do you owe on your trade?"
- X "Are you serious about buying?"

Instead, ask questions that invite conversation.

Better Questions

INSTEAD OF	SAY
Instead of: "Can I help you?"	Say: "Welcome! What brought you in today?"
Instead of: "Are you buying today?"	Say: "What made today a good day to come in?"
Instead of: "What's your budget?"	Say: "What does the perfect purchase look like for you?"
Instead of: "What payment do you want?"	Say: "When you picture this making sense financially, what does that look like?"

Becoming Instantly Likable

Customers don't expect perfection.

They expect authenticity.

Here's how to become someone people enjoy buying from:

- ✓ Smile before you speak.
- ✓ Use the customer's name naturally.
- ✓ Listen more than you talk.
- ✓ Be genuinely curious.
- ✓ Never interrupt.
- ✓ Celebrate their excitement.
- ✓ Compliment their current vehicle when appropriate.
- ✓ Laugh naturally.
- ✓ Never act desperate.
- ✓ Focus on helping, not convincing.

People buy from people who make them feel comfortable.

Practice Drill

Role-play this scenario with another salesperson.

One person is the customer.

The other is the salesperson.

Your goal is to spend the first three minutes:

- ✓ Building rapport.
- ✓ Asking questions.
- ✓ Learning about the customer.

You are not allowed to discuss price, payments, financing, or discounts.

At the end of the exercise, the “customer” should answer one question:

“Would I enjoy buying a vehicle from this person?”

If the answer is “yes,” you’re on the right track.

Key Takeaways

- ✓ First impressions happen immediately.
- ✓ Customers decide if they trust you before they trust your product.
- ✓ Great body language communicates confidence and professionalism.
- ✓ Rapport is built by listening, not talking.
- ✓ Different personalities require different approaches.
- ✓ The right questions create conversations; the wrong questions create resistance.
- ✓ Customers remember how you made them feel long after they forget the exact words you said.

Sales Coach's Challenge

Your goal isn't to be the first salesperson who speaks to the customer.

Your goal is to become the salesperson they ask for by name.

That's the difference between someone who sells a few cars each month and someone who builds a career fueled by repeat business and referrals.

B L A M O C L O S I N G

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